

Lesson 19: Petition

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26



For your submission

Please check your rubric and criteria in it, including

- ❑ Did I justify the reason for my choice of the current graph type in the paragraph?
- ❑ Did I give a half-inch indentation to the first line of all paragraphs except for the first paragraph after the section heading?
- ❑ Is my page set up properly: A4 and 1' margins?
- ❑ Did I introduce all graphics (table/graph) in text properly and explain their noticeable pattern(s) clearly?
- ❑ ...

Today's objective

**Write a persuasive petition
using rhetorical techniques**

Write a persuasive petition using rhetorics

Determine your call to action (what do you want to happen?)

Determine your audience

Create your appeals

Draft your petition

Scenario

Situation:

- You are a student at FutureNow University. The university's cell phone policy states that phones are allowed on campus but need to be turned off in class.

Today's task:

- In pairs, you are going to draft a petition to the university senate to convince them to revise the policy.

Who will be the audience for the petition?
(Age – Gender – Profession – Anything relevant)

Two target audiences

Build your argument to speak to both your audiences:

- The senate you are aiming to convince
- The people who will join your petition and co-sign it

Positions:

- More access to cell phones on campus
- Less access to cell phones on campus
- Or else

Pair activity



1. In your pairs, take 15 mins to fill the table in the next slide.
 - a. Brainstorm your ideas first
 - b. Then spend 7-8 minutes researching online
 - c. Here is a link to get started:
<https://debatewise.org/3421-should-the-cell-phones-be-allowed-in-schools/>
2. After 15 minutes, you will be paired with another group who has the same position.

Position Taken on use of cellphones	
One Pathos Appeal	
One Logos Appeal	
An Ethos Appeal	

Pairify

You've been paired with another group. Share your appeals, and decide on the best in each category. What makes these appeals effective?

Debrief

What guidelines would you establish for a pathos appeal? Are some emotional arguments simply not ethical?

How many logos appeals do you think should be used in a petition? Is one enough, or do you need more?

Suggested structure of petition

1. Paragraph one: Explain your topic and point of view; establish your ethos
2. Paragraph two (or more): Clearly explain your argument using various rhetorical appeals.
 - Ideally, you should use all appeals: logos, pathos, and ethos
3. Paragraph three: Clearly state your call to action, that is, what you are asking for in the petition.

Remember you are writing for both the signers and the receivers of the petition. Appeal to all your audiences.

Save Anytown Skate Park
Petition to Godrick Goofberry, Leader of Anytown Council

Example

What
types of
appeals
are
made,
how?

We, the undersigned, are opposed to the proposed closure of Anytown Skate Park, which is used by hundreds of local young people. The undersigned consists of a group of local Skate Park users and community members who have seen the good the park has given the city. We call on Anytown Council to:

- reject the proposed plan to close the skate park
- fully consult with local residents on any future proposals

Anytown Skate Park is the heart and soul of the community's youth. Last year, it was used by over 1000 young people. The skate park provides a unique opportunity for young people to spend time together, socialise, and keep fit. Without it, young people's hearts will break, and the community will lose the sound of children and young adults laughing, playing, and building community. The council's own targets include encouraging young people to get more exercise and play a more active role in the community, and the Skate Park is their only resource to gather in large groups to do so. The skate park is a key way that young people can keep fit, meet neighbours, and build positive relationships.

Therefore, we call on the Council to keep the Skate Park open for the benefit of the community.

Save Anytown Skate Park
Petition to Godrick Goofberry, Leader of Anytown Council

Example

Appeal to ethos: the undersigned know the situation and have the authority to speak on the value of the park

We, the undersigned, are opposed to the proposed closure of Anytown Skate Park, which is used by hundreds of local young people. The undersigned consists of a group of local Skate Park users and community members who have seen the good the park has given the city. We call on Anytown Council to:

- reject the proposed plan to close the skate park
- fully consult with local residents on any future proposals

Appeal to Pathos: Examples of pathos can be seen in language that draws out feelings such as pride, joy, pity or anger in an audience

Anytown Skate Park is the heart and soul of the community's youth. Last year, it was used by over 1000 young people. The skate park provides a unique opportunity for young people to spend time together, socialise, and keep fit. Without it, young people's hearts will break, and the community will lose the sound of children and young adults laughing, playing, and building community. The council's own targets include encouraging young people to get more exercise and play a more active role in the community, and the Skate Park is their only resource to gather in large groups to do so. The skate park is a key way that young people can keep fit, meet neighbours, and build positive relationships.

Appeal to Logos: the use of numbers helps establish the reason and logic to their position

Therefore, we call on the Council to keep the Skate Park open for the benefit of the community.

Pair activity

Context & Position
(1 paragraph)

Reasoning
(1 paragraph)
Include:

- One pathos
- One logos
- One ethos

Call to Action
(1 paragraph)

Using your notes from the previous activity, draft a petition.

Follow the framework on the left to integrate the appeals you considered for your petition.

Be prepared to share your petition with the classmates.

Debrief

Share your appeals with the classmates.

Listeners, analyze how the appeals were used.

- How does the shared piece make an ethos appeal?
- What is its logos appeal?
- What is its pathos appeal?